

“Hey, just what is it you expect from me?” he countered. “I work hard, and I’ve tried my best to provide a good home for you and the kids.”

“True. You have,” she replied in a softer tone. “But I don’t really care about material things. I just want us to talk about these things and agree, but you treat me like I’m some kind of an idiot when it comes to finances. You listen to everyone else’s advice but not mine.”

*I wish I could really be honest with her, Bud thought. If I could just once share how I feel without her saying, “I told you so.”*

“Bud, when will you finally admit that you don’t really want my help?” Sandi said as he started to leave the room. “But maybe this time you’ve gotten yourself in deep enough to admit that you actually need me.”

During the following months Bud’s situation grew worse. The disgruntled investor continued to pursue the lawsuit. And Bud continued to hide most of the facts from Sandi, believing that he was sparing her the emotional trauma he was experiencing. Then one day Sandi read in the local newspaper that all of their property and possessions were listed for possible auction by the district court, pending an upcoming assessment for investment fraud against Bud.

When Bud came home that evening, Sandi vented the frustration she had been feeling for years. Not that their marriage was all bad—in many ways they had a better marriage than most, and they had shared many pleasant times together. But Sandi had always felt like an observer in their finances, instead of a partner.

“You told me that lawsuit would amount to nothing,” she shouted, “and now I find out from reading the paper that we have a judgment against us! Is that what you call nothing?”

“I’m sorry, Sandi. I wanted to tell you weeks ago that the judge had decided against us, but I just didn’t know how.”

“I thought you told me there was nothing to that suit. How could you have lost?”